

Soc 111 Summer Session A Syllabus (2021)

Instructor: Isaac Jilbert

Welcome!

I'm excited to be teaching Social Networks. Using network methods is one of my preferred ways of developing insights about the social world. It's a powerful method that has been used to examine a range of topics from crashes in Formula 1 racing to the emergence of factions that led to the English Civil War. In this class, we will be learning the basics of network methods. While each of the individual tools are simple enough once you come to understand them, when applied to a research question, they can become incredibly powerful for creating unique insights.

Schedule

Week 1: Graphs

Read: Chapters 1 and 2 (don't worry about 2.3)

Tuesday 6/22: Introduction and Relationships as Graphs

Thursday 6/24: Relationships as Graphs Continued

Week 2: Matrices

Read: Chapters 3 and 4.1-4.4.7

Tuesday 6/29: Weights, Start Matrices, **HW 1 Due**

Thursday 7/1: Matrices

Week 3: Network Properties

Read: Chapter 5 & Unwritten Chapter on Subgraphs

Tuesday 7/6: Graph Properties, **HW 2 Due**

Thursday 7/8: Subgraphs

Week 4: Network Properties Pt 2.

Read: Chapter 6 and 7

Tuesday 7/13: Network Centrality, **HW 3 Due**

Thursday 7/15: Ego Network Properties

Week 5: Back to Matrices

Read: Chapters 4.8-4.11 and 8

Tuesday 7/20: Matrix Operations, **HW 4 Due**

Thursday 7/22: Affiliation Networks

Week 6: Using Networks

Read: TBA

Tuesday 7/29: Cohesion & Groups | Network Status Competition | Diffusion, **HW 5 Due**

Thursday 8/1: Final Exam Day

Grading

Distribution of Points:

Problem Sets: 5 sets, 14% each

Final Exam: 30% Online on last Thursday of class

Attending Lab: 2.5% Extra Credit

Grading Policy

Given that each lab/section which is attended is worth .5% extra credit towards the final grade, requests for additional extra credit will not be entertained. In addition, no requests for dropping homework's or the final exam will be entertained.

The final exam will be posted at 9am and will be available to be taken until 9pm on August 1st. It will be open note and open book, but communication with other students/people is not permitted. Note that you will have 1.5 or 2 hours to complete the exam (depends on how long it is). The test is designed such that if you do not know the material, being open book/note will be of limited use. While it may help on a problem here and there, the time spent searching for material will outweigh the time limit at a certain point. Thus, to attain success on the final, it is best to be familiar with the material and not rely on books/notes.

The primary learning tool in this class is the homework. Not only is it most of your grade, but I fully believe that learning networks is best done by actively working with networks and their concepts. As the class moves quickly, I am not able to give much in the way of extensions on homework. Every day of late homework is penalized .25 of the 14 total points (.18% of the total course grade). After a week, I am no longer able to accept the homework, as the previous grades will be released one week after the original due date. Homework is due on Tuesday's at 9pm PDT.

While I have no problem with students helping each other on HW together, the emphasis is on *helping*. Rote copying or posting answers in the group-chat is frowned upon and may result in action. Helping each other work through the logic is reasonable.

Class Times

Zoom link:

<https://ucla.zoom.us/j/94700160435?pwd=Z0VOWmg5anc3R09xRHRURXJlSThTQT09>

Lecture:

11am-1 Tuesday
11am-1 Thursday

Lab Hours:

2pm-2:50 Thursday
3pm-3:50 Thursday
Extra Lab 6pm-7 Thursday

Office Hours:

Monday 4-6pm via Zoom

Textbook

The textbook for this class is being jointly developed by me and Omar Lizardo, a professor here in the sociology department and my academic advisor. One problem with the textbook is that it's incomplete. The benefits of the textbook are that it is free! It is also being developed because the undergraduate level textbooks on networks are not great for teaching the material that we'd like to cover in our opinion. As such, the lectures are the primary source of material, and if it's not in

lecture it's not on the exam. However, there may be things in lecture that are not yet in the textbook, so be sure to watch the lectures as the definitive list of topics.

Textbook: http://olizardo.bol.ucla.edu/classes/soc-111/textbook/_book/1-intro.html#intro

General Policies

Contact

I care about your emails, and so to help me respond to you, please email me with the subject line "SOC 111 QUESTION," all capitalized, followed by anything else you'd like to add. That way I will be sure I don't mistake your email for anything else. If I don't get back to you within 24 hours, please feel free to re-email me as a nudge.

Recording Policy

You are not allowed to record sections.

Discussion Labs

Participation is fun! It's also a critical part of this class. Participating in labs can improve your understanding in the course, and so it's recommended.

Section Switching

You can switch between the labs. I prefer switches to be permanent, but contact me if you'd like a temporary switch for some reason. Just contact me for this issue as this is internal to labs, it does not require involving the registrar.

Troubled World Policy

If life is being particularly difficult, please contact us sooner rather than later so that I might help in regard to your class progress.

Accommodations

If you have any disabilities, please feel free to let me know what accommodations you might require to assist in your success with this course. It is best to reach out with the recommendation of the CAE office. If you are from another university, the CAE office may still be able to assist you, especially if you are a member at another UC campus.

Academic Integrity and Student Conduct

The standards of general respect apply in this course, as they do in every course. In addition, the work that you turn in should follow the normal standards of academic integrity (i.e. doing ones own work as defined by the assignment). If you have any concerns, please feel free to consult the [UCLA code of conduct](#).

Grade Cutoffs

97-100 A+	77-80 C+
93-97 A	73-77 C
90-93 A-	70-73 C
87-90 B+	67-70 D+
83-87 B	63-67 D
80-83 B-	<63 F